

THE \$2,500 CASE

What this is: the market research, the value maths, and the exact way to anchor a \$2,500-a-month retainer with Jitty tomorrow — with a walk-away line you can actually hold. Sections tagged **SHOW JITTY** can go straight into his proposal; sections tagged **YOUR EYES ONLY** are your playbook.

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READ THIS FIRST

THE SHORT VERSION

1. **\$2,500 is not expensive — it's under market for the scope.** Priced line by line at Australian freelance rates, what you're proposing costs \$4,800–6,200 a month. Auto-specific agencies (US) sit at \$1,500–6,000/mo *before* video. You are selling a ~50% discount, not a premium.
2. **Break-even is one used car a month.** Or eleven Standard services. Or one panel job plus six services. Say it in cars, not dollars — that's the unit Jitty thinks in.
3. **Anchor from the top.** Show a \$3,800 option first, then \$2,500 as "the one that fits you", then a deliberately thin \$1,500 that is obviously a downgrade. He should feel he's choosing the middle, not being sold the top.
4. **Lead with what he's already received.** The website, the booking flow, the tracking, the playbook, the calendar tool — roughly \$8–12k of work at market rates, delivered on trust. The trial has already run. You're not asking him to gamble; you're asking him to stop getting it free.
5. **The walk-away is a scope line, not a threat.** Below \$2,500 you cannot run a *system* — only posts. And posts are exactly what he has now. Say that plainly, once, and mean it.

WHAT THIS COSTS WHEN YOU BUY IT FROM ANYONE ELSE

Australian 2026 pricing for the pieces you're bundling. Ranges are wide because scope is wide — the number that matters is the last table, where your scope is priced out line by line.

SERVICE (AUSTRALIA, 2026)	TYPICAL PRICE	NOTES
Freelance social media manager, light	\$500–1,500 / mo	Few posts, one or two platforms, no video, no filming
Agency social management, small business	\$1,000–2,000 / mo	Two platforms, graphics + captions, monthly report. Video costs extra
Agency social management with video	\$2,000–8,000 / mo	"Most owners who want it genuinely handled end up in the low thousands"
Social content package (video-led)	from \$2,000 / mo	Vidico's floor for ongoing short-form content
Videographer, day rate	\$800–2,500 / day	Editing billed separately, \$50–110 / hr
Batch of 3–6 short-form videos, one shoot day	\$3,000–8,000	Shot and edited for Instagram / YouTube — a single batch
Editing only, one reel	\$30–150 each	You supply footage; they cut it
UGC creator, per video	\$150–800 each	Beginner to intermediate; established creators \$1,000+
Auto-repair marketing agencies (US)	US\$1,500–6,000 / mo	Shop Marketing Pros: US\$2,899–4,795/mo on 18-month terms. Ad spend on top
In-house social media manager	\$80–95k / yr	≈ \$7,500–8,800 / mo once super and on-costs are added

Your scope, priced at the bottom of those ranges

WHAT YOU'RE PROPOSING (PER MONTH)	MARKET LOW	MARKET HIGH
4 × half-day shoots at the workshop (3 reels each)	\$1,600	\$3,000
~20 reels edited, captioned, thumbnailed, scheduled	\$1,000	\$2,000
Weekly used-car inventory video	\$300	\$600
Instagram + Facebook + community groups run daily	\$800	\$1,500
Google Business Profile: photos, posts, reviews, Q&A	\$300	\$600

Website upkeep — listings, prices, booking flow, tracking	\$300	\$600
Fortnightly performance report + strategy call	\$400	\$800
Market total	\$4,700	\$9,100
What you're asking	\$2,500 — roughly half the market floor	

The sentence for Jitty: "If you rang an agency in Adelaide for exactly this, the cheapest quote you'd get is about five thousand a month. I'm asking for half, because I already know your business."

ALREADY DELIVERED

SHOW JITTY

WHAT HE HAS RECEIVED SO FAR — ON TRUST

This is the most persuasive slide you own and you're the only one who can present it. Every line is real, and every line has a market price. He's been getting the trial for free; tomorrow is the day it becomes a partnership.

Website rebuilt — mobile-first, services, used cars, paint & panel, reviews, map, schema **\$3,000–8,000**

Booking flow — date picker, car make / model / year / km, issue description, straight into WhatsApp as a quote-ready lead **\$1,500–3,000**

Service pricing tiers — Basic \$149 / Standard \$229 / Premium \$329, desktop table + phone cards **\$400–800**

Used-car listings — per-car WhatsApp buttons so we know which car every enquiry is about **\$600–1,200**

Google Analytics + tracked links — Instagram, Google, Facebook, groups each measured separately **\$500–1,500**

Booking confirmation + calendar invites — a tool that sends customers a real calendar invite **\$1,000–2,000**

Reel Playbook — the content strategy, ten ready-to-shoot scripts, the standard CTA **\$800–1,500**

Bio-link animation, thumbnails, Google profile + Facebook page links fixed

\$400–900

Total — delivered before a single invoice

≈ \$8,000–19,000

Use the low end out loud ("about eight thousand dollars of work") — it's unarguable, and understatement reads as confidence.

THE VALUE MATHS

SHOW JITTY

WHAT \$2,500 HAS TO BRING BACK

This is the section that moves an owner. Not "engagement" — **cars through the door.**

\$82

per day — what \$2,500 / month costs. Less than one hour of workshop labour

1 car

one used-car sale's margin (≈ \$1,500–2,500) covers most or all of the month

11

Standard services at \$229 = \$2,519. Roughly one extra booking every three days

\$5,500

what one *retained* customer is worth over 8 years at Jitty's prices (2 visits / yr × \$229 × 1.5 cars). US benchmark: \$14,000

Break-even, in the units Jitty counts

MIX THAT PAYS FOR THE MONTH	CARS SERVICED	USED CARS SOLD	PANEL JOBS
Service-only	11 Standard	—	—
Balanced (most realistic)	4	1	—
Panel-led	6	—	1 (\$800+ job)
One good week	2	1	1

Everything past that line is profit — and the point of a system is that it doesn't stop at break-even. A customer won by a reel this month is still coming back in 2030. Retention programs alone lift workshop revenue 15–25% a year; shops that run them keep 60–70% of customers instead of watching them drift to whoever's cheaper on Google that week.

Say it as a question: "If this brings you one extra used-car buyer a month, does it pay for itself?" Let him answer. He'll say yes — and now he's made the argument for you.

THE COMPOUND EFFECT — AND WHY RANDOM POSTING THROWS IT AWAY

What Jitty does now: post when he remembers, get a spike when something lands, nothing follows. That's the pattern that makes owners say "social media doesn't work". It does — but only the parts that *accumulate*.

ASSET	HOW IT COMPOUNDS	WHAT KILLS IT
Content library	Every symptom reel keeps getting found — Instagram, TikTok and Google all index reels as search results now. A "brakes squealing?" video posted in September still books jobs in March.	Random topics with no CTA. Views with nowhere to go.
Followers	Each viral reel converts a slice of viewers into followers who see the <i>next</i> one. 50 reels at 2% is a local audience that shows up for every post.	A viral hit with no next post. The audience arrives and finds an empty room.
Google reviews	91% of consumers say verified reviews drive their confidence. Compared side by side, the mechanic with more reviews wins without the customer thinking about it.	Not asking. Every unreviewed happy customer is a compounding loss.
Google Business Profile	Profiles with 10+ photos get up to 2× the customer actions; photos alone bring 42% more direction requests. 76–88% of local searchers act within 24 hours.	A profile last updated when the shop opened.
The website funnel	Every reel now ends at a door that collects make, model, year, km and the problem before WhatsApp even opens. The door doesn't get tired.	"DM me" — leads lost in a chat thread nobody follows up.

The evidence from content that's measured: consistent programs show ROI climbing year on year (one benchmark set: ~300% at month 12, ~700% at month 24, ~1,100% at month 36) because the old content is still working while the new content is added. Paid ads stop the moment the money stops; organic content is the only channel where month 18 is cheaper than month 1.

The line: "You've already had a video go viral. What did you get from it? That's not a video problem — that's a system problem. The system is what I'm selling."

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN A WORKSHOP TAKES THIS SERIOUSLY

Royalty Auto Service, St Marys, Georgia. A father-and-son independent shop. Two years of consistent short-form video — not polished, just real repairs explained to camera. Result: customers now drive from Alabama, the Carolinas and Delaware, some staying overnight in a hotel, to get their car fixed at "the shop from YouTube". A third location is opening. Their own advice from the trade press: *simpler topics perform best* (their breakout video was a window reset), and *authenticity beats polish every time*. That's Jitty's exact advantage — he's authentic on camera already.

Australia. The honest picture: no Australian workshop has gone that big on video yet — which is the opportunity, not the caveat. What the local data does show is that the decision is made online: car owners Google first, and the workshop in the top three map results with the best reviews gets the booking. AutoGuru's national "Top Mechanics" list is built on review volume. A Brisbane workshop with only 260 Instagram followers has held a top-5 AutoGuru rating three years running — the lesson being that *local trust signals* (reviews, profile, consistency) matter more than follower counts. Jitty has the 5.0★ rating; the system's job is to point every video at it.

THE COMMUNITY EDGE NO AGENCY CAN COPY

22.8% of Australians speak a language other than English at home. India is now among the top five countries of birth (673,000 people), up 47.9% in five years — the fastest-growing community in the country. Brands that speak to multicultural customers directly see 15–20% higher retention with those customers.

Jitty already gets most of his work from the Adelaide Indian Community groups. An agency would treat that as a footnote. Your system treats it as the core: a Malayalam or Hindi hook line on the reels shared into the groups, in-language captions on the ones that matter, the community-group links tracked separately so you both see which group sends the customers. Nobody else in Salisbury is doing this. That is the moat.

Frame it as protecting what he built: "The groups are rented land — one admin change and you're gone. The website, the reviews, the followers are yours. I'm moving your customers onto land you own."

YOUR OWN NUMBERS

SHOW JITTY

THE EVIDENCE YOU ALREADY HAVE

44%

of all website visits
come from the
Instagram bio link —
the reels are already
the engine

29.9K

Instagram views in 30
days, from unplanned
posting

2–3×

website traffic on the
days a reel lands,
versus quiet days

1 → ?

Cyril's ABS booking:
reel → link → car
details → WhatsApp. It
works once. The
system makes it
happen weekly.

If you get the Instagram Insights screenshots before the meeting (90-day views, link taps, follower growth, follower / non-follower split), put them beside these — Instagram's numbers and Google's numbers agreeing is the most credible thing you can show.

PRICING ARCHITECTURE

YOUR EYES ONLY

THREE OPTIONS — BUILT SO HE PICKS THE MIDDLE

People choose the middle. Your job is to make the top credible, the bottom obviously thin, and the middle exactly what you want. The top isn't a decoy — you'd deliver it happily — but it exists so that \$2,500 reads as reasonable rather than as the ceiling.

MAINTAIN

\$1,500 / mo

"Keep the lights on"

- 2 reels a week — *Jitty films*, you edit
- Instagram + Facebook page managed
- Google profile kept current
- Monthly report
- ~~Filming days at the workshop~~
- ~~Weekly used-car video~~
- ~~Community group system~~
- ~~Website upkeep~~

RECOMMENDED

GROW

\$2,500 / mo

"The system"

- **5 posts a week** — 3 filmed by you at a weekly half-day shoot, 2 by Jitty
- **Weekly used-car inventory video**
- Instagram + Facebook + community groups, daily
- Google profile: photos, posts, review requests
- Photography at every shoot
- Website kept current — listings, prices, booking flow
- 2-week content buffer, always
- Fortnightly report + call

DOMINATE

\$3,800 / mo

"Own Salisbury"

- Everything in Grow
- **In-language pack** — Malayalam / Hindi / Punjabi hooks and captions
- Paid boosting managed (ad spend on top)
- Monthly review-generation campaign to every customer
- Two shoot days a month
- Quarterly strategy session
- 48-hour turnaround on anything

Terms that protect you

- **6-month minimum, price locked.** Content compounds; three months proves nothing and he'll judge it at month two. Say "six months, we review at three" — the review makes the six feel safe.
- **Paid on the 1st, in advance.** Not "end of month". You're funding shoots and tools up front.
- **Ad spend, print, and paid tools are his.** Your fee is your work. Never absorb Meta's bill.
- **Add-ons instead of discounts.** If he wants more than Grow but balks at Dominate: in-language pack +\$450, extra shoot day +\$450, boosting management +\$400 or 15% of spend. The \$2,500 base never moves; the "more" you want comes from here.
- **What you'll never do:** guarantee virality, guarantee a booking count, or work without the two-week buffer. Say the first two out loud — refusing to promise is what makes the rest believable.

The one number you don't know: his revenue. Australian small businesses spend 7–10% of revenue on marketing; \$2,500 a month sits at 7–10% of \$25–36k a month (\$300–430k a year). If he does that, this is a normal budget. If he does much less — say under \$20k a month — \$2,500 is over 12% and will feel like a bite, and you'll need the used-car margin argument to do the heavy lifting. Try to find out

before you quote, even roughly: "How many cars a week do you put through?" × his average ticket gets you close enough.

HOW TO ANCHOR IT YOUR EYES ONLY

THE ORDER OF THE CONVERSATION

Value-based selling means the price arrives last, after he's already agreed on what it's worth. Don't let the number come up early. If he asks, say "I'll get to that — I want to show you what you're paying for first," and keep going.

- 1 Open with what he's already got.** Walk the "already delivered" list, out loud, in his shop, on his phone. Show him the booking flow working. End with the low number.

"That's about eight thousand dollars of work, done on a handshake. I did it because I believed the business deserved it. Now I want to show you what happens when it's a system instead of a favour."

- 2 Show his own numbers.** The 44%, the 29.9K, the spike days, Cyril's booking. Not slides — the actual analytics screen.

"Your reels are already 44% of your website traffic. You did that without trying. Imagine five a week, every week, all ending at the same door."

- 3 Name the failure mode without blaming him.**

"You had one go viral. What did we get from it? Nothing — because nothing was ready to catch it. That's not your fault; it's what happens without a system."

- 4 Ask the break-even question and wait.**

"If this brings you one extra used-car buyer a month — just one — does it pay for itself?" Then say nothing until he answers.

5 Give the market number before yours.

"If you rang an agency for this — filming, editing, five posts a week, the groups, Google, the website — the cheapest quote you'd get is about five thousand a month."

6 Present three options, top first. Slide the sheet across. Describe Dominate in two sentences, then Grow in four, then Maintain in one — dismissively.

"Dominate is where we'd go if you wanted to own the whole area. Grow is the one I've built for you — it's the system, everything we talked about. Maintain is just me editing what you film — it's what you have now with a nicer finish."

7 Say the price once, then stop talking.

"Grow is two and a half thousand a month, six months, we review at three." Silence. The first person to speak loses. Let him.

When he pushes back

"That's a lot of money."

Agree, then reframe the unit. "It is. It's also eighty-two dollars a day — less than an hour on the hoist. And it's half what anyone else would charge for the same thing. What I'm asking is whether one extra car a month is worth eighty-two dollars a day."

"I get my customers from the Facebook groups anyway."

Don't argue — absorb it. "You do, and the groups are in the plan — every reel goes into them, with a link that shows us which group sends people. But the groups are rented. One admin change and you're gone. Everything I'm building — the reviews, the followers, the website — is yours."

"Can't I just keep doing it myself?"

Price his time. "You can. It's ten hours a week done properly, and your hour is worth more on a car than on a phone. Ten hours of your labour a week is six thousand dollars a month. I'm cheaper than you are."

"Can we do three months and see?"

Hold six, give the review. "Three months is exactly long enough to decide it isn't working before it's had a chance to. Six months, and at three we sit down with the numbers — if they're not moving, I'll tell you first."

"Can you do it for two thousand?"

Trade scope, never price. "I can do two thousand — that's Maintain plus one shoot a month. What comes out is the weekly used-car video and the groups system. Which of those do you want to lose?" He won't want to lose either. That's the point.

THE WALK-AWAY LINE: "BELOW THIS IT'S NOT A SYSTEM, IT'S POSTS — AND POSTS ARE WHAT YOU'VE GOT NOW. I'D RATHER NOT DO IT THAN DO IT IN A WAY THAT LETS YOU SAY SOCIAL MEDIA DOESN'T WORK."

Say it calmly, once, and mean it. This isn't a threat — it's the most credible sentence in the meeting, because it's the only one where you're arguing against your own interest. If he still says no, thank him, leave the sheet, and tell him the offer stands for a fortnight. Then actually stop the unpaid work.

Don'ts

- Don't say "I think" or "maybe" anywhere near the price. "It's two and a half thousand." Full stop.
- Don't apologise for the number, and don't fill the silence after it.
- Don't discount. Every dollar you drop without removing scope tells him the first number was padding.
- Don't promise virality or a booking count. Promise the system, the cadence, and the report.
- Don't pitch in the workshop with cars waiting. Ask for 30 minutes sitting down — a chai, a phone, the sheet.

HONEST CAVEATS

YOUR EYES ONLY

WHAT COULD GO WRONG,

AND WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

- **Five posts a week is a real load for one person.** The two-week buffer isn't a nice-to-have — it's what stops one sick week from breaking the promise. Build it before you need it.
- **Jitty's two videos a week are the weak link.** Give him the ten scripts, a phone tripod, and a Sunday reminder. If he doesn't film, don't let the cadence drop — you fill the gap with photo posts and the inventory video, and you say so in the report.
- **Month two is when he'll doubt it.** Followers move first, leads move later. Your fortnightly report should show leading indicators (views, link taps, profile actions) so the lag doesn't look like failure.
- **The multilingual content needs a native speaker.** If that's not you for Hindi or Punjabi, price a translator into the Dominate tier and keep Malayalam in Grow.
- **The ROI benchmarks above are from measured content programs, mostly B2B and SEO-led.** Use them for the *shape* of the argument (old content keeps working), not as a promise of 300%.

NEXT

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER YOU PICK THE NUMBER

Once you've decided whether Grow sits at \$2,500 or higher, the Jitty-facing proposal gets built from the **SHOW JITTY** sections of this brief: a one-page cover (what he's received, his numbers, the break-even), the three-option sheet, and a terms page. Two pages he can hold, not a deck.

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- Australian social media management pricing: [CodeQy](#) · [Catalyst Communications](#) · [Ziff Digital](#) · [ReelMonth](#) · [Workspacein SMB report](#)
- Video production and creator rates: [Vidico](#) · [Queen Charles](#) · [Bridge PR UGC guide](#) · [beCreatives](#)
- Auto-repair marketing pricing: [Shop Marketing Pros](#) · [Media Spearhead](#) · [Auto Shop Digital](#)
- Customer value and retention: [DriveLine](#) · [Launch Advisor](#) · [iKon Technologies](#)
- Local search and Google Business Profile: [WiserNotify](#) · [Searchlab](#) · [SeoProfy](#)
- Short-form video: [Vidico](#) · [Kapwing](#)
- Compounding content ROI: [Terakeet](#) · [Genesys Growth](#) · [20North](#)
- Mechanic case study and Australian trust signals: [Ratchet & Wrench on Royalty Auto Service](#) · [Motor1](#) · [AutoGuru Top Mechanics](#) · [Clue](#)
- Multicultural Australia: [Marketing Mag](#) · [CulturalPulse](#) · [Leba](#)
- Marketing budget benchmarks: [Pixelibri](#) · [Boomcycle](#) · [SEEK salary data](#)

